
Chapter 11 — Group 11

ONLY YOU CONTROL WHAT YOU DO

[Instructions: Read this chapter prior to coming to your next group. Answer the questions before coming to group. *You will share your responses to the questions in group.*]

This small workbook has repeatedly stated that each of us only controls ourselves and our behavior. And some people don't do a very good job at that. So, how do you feel about your relationships now? Do you feel your life and your relationships are out of your control? Do you have some genuine acceptance about what you can and cannot control? Do you feel better about yourself?

Untangling yourself from problem relationships is a way of gaining freedom to become yourself. Sometimes people are so wrapped up in others' problems that they lose themselves. They become a false person — trapped by misguided attempts to control. Once you understand how you have become tangled in others' feelings and behavior, you can become free to explore your own abilities and desires. Hopefully, you have more than begun that process and are well on your way to real happiness and meaning in your life.

The purpose of this program has not been to have you terminate your problem relationships. However, it may be that ending a relationship is the right thing to do — and the only good choice. But our bigger purpose was to have you take control of yourself and to become realistic about how much you can control others. Your happiness rests on your shoulders. It is foolish to place your happiness and purpose in life in another person's hands.

1. Good Times & Bad Times

Begin this exercise by listing the 5 best times you have ever had with other people. Think about all of your life and write something about each experience below.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

Now, list the 5 worst times you have ever had with other people. Think about all of your life and write something about each experience below.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

In looking at your 5 good times, how much control did you have? Did you cause the experience? Did you have a good, acceptant attitude? What was it that made each good time so good? Answer these questions below. _____

In looking at your 5 bad times, how much control did you have? Did you cause the experience? Did you have a negative attitude? What was it that made each bad time so bad? Answer these questions below. In group, you will be asked to answer a few questions about what you wrote.

2. Where Do You Think You Are Right Now?

Before ending this chapter, the next to last in the program, you need to take a good look at yourself and your relationships. *You do not have to share everything* you write here in group.

Do you believe you have made any progress in problem relationships since you entered this program?

Is there something else can you do to work on your problem relationships? _____

Look back at the things you checked in Chapter 10 (page 24). Which of those issues do you believe you need to work on? _____

Do you need to ask the group or your facilitator to point you in the direction of more help? _____

Is there anything you want to say to the facilitator? _____

Do you want to meet individually with the group facilitator? _____

If you have filled out this chapter before group and successfully shared your responses in group, you will be asked to move on to the next chapter. Remember that you do not have to share all of the things you wrote in the last section of this chapter.